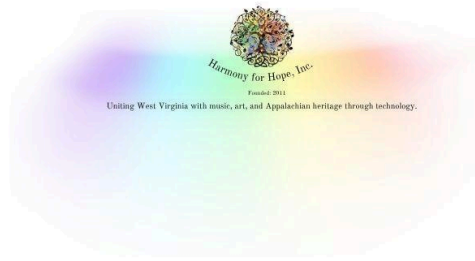


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EIN: 81-1907024

# Thurmond Heritage Node — Council Information Packet

**Submitted by:** Harmony for Hope, Inc. in partnership with Kidd's Technical Services

**Contact:** Carrie Kidd, Harmony for Hope | [ekidd@harmonyforhopewv.org](mailto:ekidd@harmonyforhopewv.org)

**NPS Corridor Contact:** Eve West, National Park Service, New River Gorge National Park & Preserve

**Project documentation:** <https://github.com/H4HWV2011/msjarvis-public-docs>

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## What Is Being Requested

Harmony for Hope is requesting that the Town of Thurmond provide a Letter of Support for the New River Gorge Heritage & Visitor Connectivity Mesh Pilot — a community heritage and connectivity initiative being advanced for grant applications and partnership development with New River Gorge National Park and Preserve.

**No municipal funding is requested. No installation or site authorization is requested at this stage. This is a concept support letter only.**

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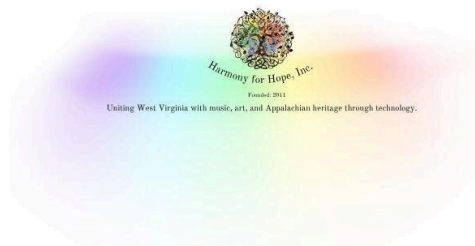
## About Harmony for Hope and Kidd's Technical Services

**Harmony for Hope, Inc.** is a nonprofit organization based at 704 & 708 Main Street in Mount Hope, West Virginia. Harmony for Hope operates as the program sponsor for MountainShares — a community-owned local economy and heritage platform being developed in southern West Virginia.

**Kidd's Technical Services** develops and operates the technology infrastructure under contract to Harmony for Hope. The platform — the Artificial Learning & Location Intelligence System (ALLIS) — is a locally hosted intelligence system that stores heritage content, visitor

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information, and safety guidance on-site. Because content lives in the community rather than on a distant cloud server, it serves visitors regardless of carrier or signal conditions.

This project has received an independent letter of professional support from **Dr. Anurag K. Srivastava**, Raymond J. Lane Professor and Chair of the Lane Department of Computer Science and Electrical Engineering at West Virginia University, who reviewed the methodology and described it as a sound approach to validating advanced AI models in a real-world, resource-constrained setting.

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## The Project: Where We Are and Where We Are Going

Harmony for Hope is currently building and testing the pilot infrastructure in Mount Hope — the lead anchor community where the ALLIS platform and MountainShares Commons are live and in active development. Mount Hope has an operating nonprofit with a physical presence, an established 1.25-mile Historic Walking Trail with sixteen interpretive points, and an existing relationship with the National Park Service. The City of Mount Hope has provided a Letter of Support.

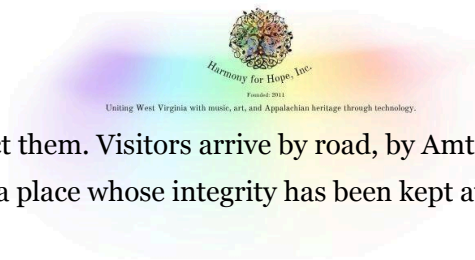
Eve West with the National Park Service has indicated support for the project and is prepared to formally advance corridor engagement once Thurmond's letter is in hand.

The long-term vision is a corridor-scale mesh serving gateway communities along the 53-mile New River Gorge corridor — Fayetteville, Oak Hill, Hinton, Ansted, and beyond. Each community hosts a locally owned node, telling its own story, on its own terms. Mount Hope is the first step. Thurmond is where the model is carried into the most demanding and most consequential environment it will face.

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## Thurmond

Thurmond has preserved something that almost no other place in the United States still holds: a complete, intact record of the coal and railroad economy that built industrial America. The NPS-restored Depot. The grade crossings. The structures that survived because the people who



stayed here and chose to protect them. Visitors arrive by road, by Amtrak's Cardinal, by excursion train — and they walk through a place whose integrity has been kept at considerable cost and with considerable conviction.

Cellular coverage in Thurmond is inconsistent across carriers and unreliable for the visitor population at large. But connectivity was never the full problem. Even a visitor with a strong signal cannot access locally hosted, context-aware heritage content — because none exists. The story that lives here — coal, labor, rail, river — is one of the most complete industrial narratives in Appalachia. Most visitors leave with only a fraction of it.

A Thurmond node — **MS.THURMOND.ALLIS** — would give that story a way to travel with the visitors who come to hear it, in a form that respects everything Thurmond has worked to preserve. If this model can be built to serve Thurmond — with NPS-managed land, federal permitting at every step, and a community that has always governed itself on principle — it can be built to serve any heritage site in the world where preservation and connectivity have never coexisted.

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## What the Technology Does

When a visitor connects to an ALLIS node:

- They connect to locally hosted content — heritage stories, site interpretation, maps, and safety information — served from within the community itself.
- They access interpretive material developed by NPS and local partners in formats that deepen what printed signs and ranger-led walks introduce.
- They receive context-specific safety information for river access, trails, and emergency guidance tailored to the immediate landscape.

In Thurmond, the node would be deployed at a site determined collaboratively with NPS, subject to all applicable federal review. It would complement — not replace or compete with — existing NPS interpretation and signage.

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## The Cost and Commitment Model

Community partners in this program do not pay for participation. Harmony for Hope, through the MountainShares Sponsorship Tier, covers the cost of hardware installation and ongoing operation at no cost to the host community.

Thurmond's contribution, if it chooses to host a node, would be:

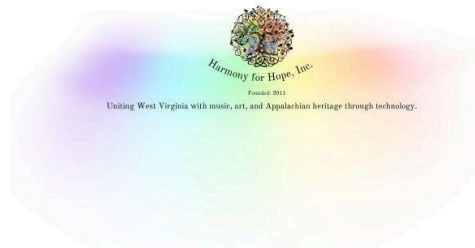
- Site access for appropriate hardware placement, determined collaboratively with NPS.
- A point of contact for coordination.
- Participation in evaluation and feedback.

Every participating community executes a simple **Corridor Partner Community Governance Agreement** with Kidd's Technical Services. That agreement:

- Confirms the no-cost deployment model.
- Protects locally generated heritage and operational data as a community resource.
- Preserves the partner's intellectual property rights over content they contribute.
- Allows termination with notice, with hardware removal and surface restoration included.

For federal partners, an added **Federal Agency Participation Carve-Out** confirms that the agreement is not a procurement, does not obligate federal funds, and does not override federal records or privacy law.

**The Town of Thurmond is not being asked to pay for, manage, or take technical responsibility for this infrastructure.**



## Project Status

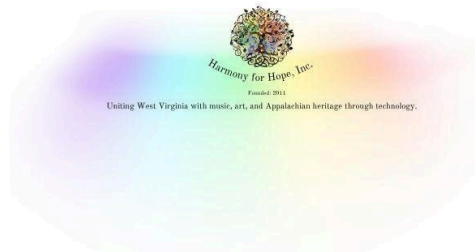
| Element                         | Status                                                                                                            |
|---------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Technology platform (Ms. Allis) | Live and in active testing at<br><a href="https://egeria.mountainshares.us">https://egeria.mountainshares.us</a>  |
| MountainShares Commons          | Live and in active testing                                                                                        |
| Red team testing                | First external users onboarded                                                                                    |
| NPS engagement                  | Conceptual support indicated; formalization awaiting community letters                                            |
| Academic validation             | Letter of support received from WVU Lane Department Chair, Dr. A.K. Srivastava                                    |
| Development partner             | Starry Eyes Media, Princeton WV                                                                                   |
| Target deployment               | Mount Hope, April 2027                                                                                            |
| Public project documentation    | <a href="https://github.com/H4HWV2011/msjarvis-public-docs">https://github.com/H4HWV2011/msjarvis-public-docs</a> |

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## What the Council Is Being Asked to Support

A Letter of Support stating that the Town of Thurmond:

1. Recognizes the public value of the New River Gorge Heritage & Visitor Connectivity Mesh Pilot as a heritage interpretation and visitor safety initiative consistent with Thurmond's mission as a preserved rail and coal community.
2. Supports Harmony for Hope's use of the letter in grant applications and partnership discussions with the National Park Service and other agencies.
3. Supports continued exploration of Thurmond's role as a node in the corridor pilot, subject to all applicable NPS permitting and federal governance processes.



4. Is willing to participate in further conversations about site-specific implementation if funding is secured.

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## What the Council Is NOT Approving

The Letter of Support does not:

- Obligate the Town to provide funding of any kind.
- Authorize installation of hardware at any specific site.
- Waive or replace any NPS permitting, special use, visual impact, or Section 106 review processes.
- Commit the Town to a contract or operating agreement.
- Bind the Town to support final implementation if later details are not acceptable.

**This is a concept endorsement for grant and partnership development purposes only.** All implementation details, site selections, and operational agreements — including all applicable federal review processes — would be addressed before any physical deployment.

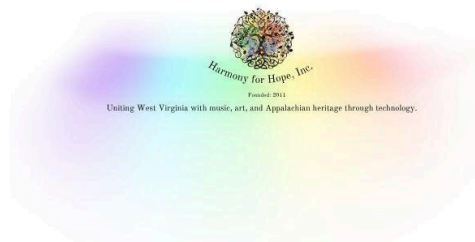
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## Suggested Agenda Note

Request from Harmony for Hope for Town Council consideration of a Letter of Support for the New River Gorge Heritage & Visitor Connectivity Mesh Pilot — a heritage interpretation and visitor connectivity initiative being advanced for grant applications and partnership development with the National Park Service. No municipal funding, site authorization, or procurement is requested at this stage.

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## Contact

### Carrie Kidd

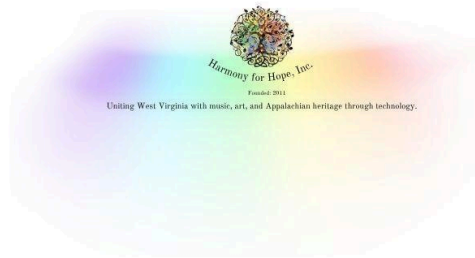
Founder, Harmony for Hope, Inc. | Principal, Kidd's Technical Services

[ckidd@harmonyforhopewv.org](mailto:ckidd@harmonyforhopewv.org)

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## Appendix A - Letters of Support



Benjamin M. Statler College of Engineering and Mineral Resources  
Lane Department of Computer Science and Electrical Engineering

May 12, 2026

To whom it may concern,

I am writing to express my support for the proposed New River Gorge Heritage & Visitor Connectivity Mesh Pilot being developed by Ms. Carrie Kidd. I offer these comments in my personal professional capacity and not as an official statement on behalf of West Virginia University.

As Raymond J. Lane Professor and Chairperson in the Lane Department of Computer Science and Electrical Engineering at West Virginia University, and as a researcher in resilient power and cyber-physical systems, I view this pilot as a thoughtful and appropriate first step toward validating advanced, partially unexplainable AI models in a real-world, resource-constrained setting.

In my interactions with Ms. Kidd and in reviewing her materials, I have found that:

- The focus on a single Appalachian community and a tightly scoped pilot is a sound methodological choice for early-stage validation of complex AI models.
- The combination of location intelligence, mesh connectivity, and locally hosted AI services has genuine research merit, particularly for improving safety, resilience, and situational awareness in rural and hard-to-serve areas.
- The attention she gives to data governance, robustness testing with changing datasets, and safety considerations is consistent with best practices for responsible deployment of such systems.

This letter is not an endorsement of a finished product, but rather an acknowledgment that the direction, scope, and validation approach Ms. Kidd is pursuing are on a promising track for a potentially powerful technology. In my professional opinion, a small, carefully monitored pilot such as the one she has outlined is an appropriate and meaningful way to learn about performance, robustness, and real-world impacts before scaling.

Please feel free to contact me if additional information would be helpful.

Sincerely,

Dr. Anurag K Srivastava  
Raymond J. Lane Professor and Chair  
Lane Department of Computer Science and Electrical Engineering  
AERB 363B, 1220 Evansdale Drive, PO Box 6109  
West Virginia University, Morgantown, WV 26506  
Phone: 304-293-3017, email: [anurag.srivastava@mail.wvu.edu](mailto:anurag.srivastava@mail.wvu.edu)